

The "Eroding Goals" Archetype in Film Production

Dreamland Incorporation

Independent Research Division

“Understanding systems before we change them”

Abstract

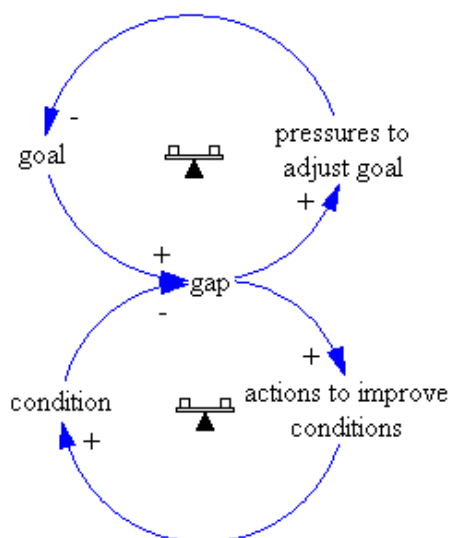
This paper examines the "Eroding Goals" archetype in the context of film production. Three scenarios are considered: balanced influence of positive and negative events, increased positive events, and increased negative events.

It is shown that negative events (schedule pressure, budget pressure, compromises) act continuously and, in the long run, outweigh periodic positive events (money injections, community support). The ideal follows film quality with a delay, reflecting a gradual adjustment to declining standards. The most stable quality is achieved when positive events are strengthened; strengthening negative events leads to an uncontrolled drop in film quality and a growing gap between quality and the ideal.

1. Introduction

The "Eroding Goals" archetype describes a system in which a symptomatic solution is used to substitute ambitious goals with those that are easier to achieve in the current reality. A diagram of the archetype is shown in Figure 1.

Figure 1. Diagram of the "Eroding Goals" archetype



The "Eroding Goals" archetype may sound similar to "Shifting the Burden", but the key difference lies in how the final goal is treated. In "Shifting the Burden", the goal remains unchanged, but the actions and steps to achieve it are replaced with easier ones, which only delays the result. In "Eroding Goals", the actions are constant, and the goal gradually declines under their influence.

2. Model Description

Suppose a film crew takes on the adaptation of a famous literary work. The crew knows that a perfect adaptation is impossible but hopes the final film quality will reach at least 80% of the ideal 100%. Two types of events affect film quality.

Events that increase film quality:

- 1) Community support – help with the filming process, props, and costumes;
- 2) Money injections from sponsors familiar with the original work and interested in the adaptation.

Events that decrease film quality:

- 1) Schedule pressure imposed by the studio to report to investors;
- 2) Budget pressure – each crew member works at a pre-agreed rate;
- 3) Compromises – the crew agrees to lower quality just to complete the shooting.

Quality-increasing events occur periodically. Fan meetings that help grow the audience happen once a week (on weekends). Money injections occur every five days (or more often if the gap between quality and the ideal exceeds 8%).

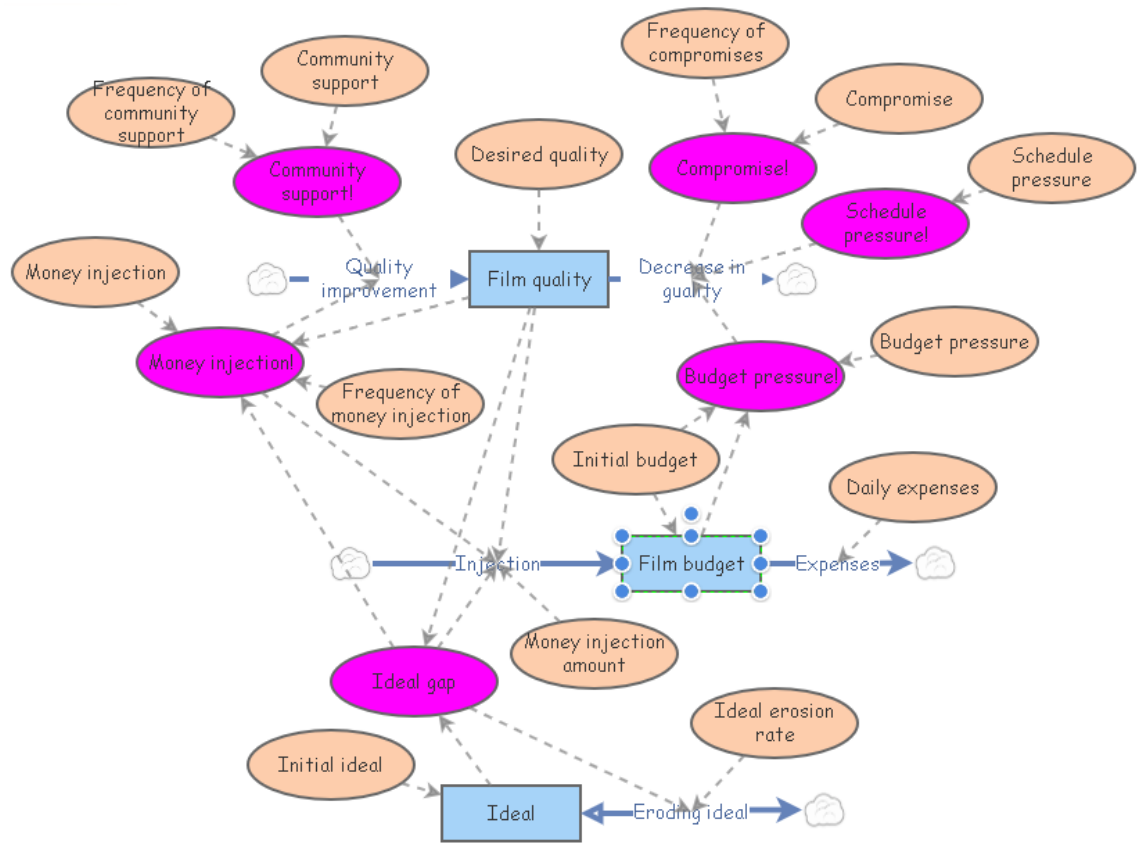
Quality-decreasing events occur continuously. The exception is compromises, which can arise unexpectedly; in this example, their average frequency is 3 days.

A series of experiments with varying event coefficients is conducted to examine the behaviour of key parameters: film quality, the ideal, and eroding ideal (goal). The following scenarios are considered:

- 1) Balanced event coefficients;
- 2) Higher positive event coefficients;
- 3) Higher negative event coefficients.

Excel was used for calculations; Insight Maker was used for model construction and result verification. The working model diagram is shown in Figure 2.

Figure 2. Model diagram in Insight Maker



2.1. Experiment with Balanced Event Coefficients

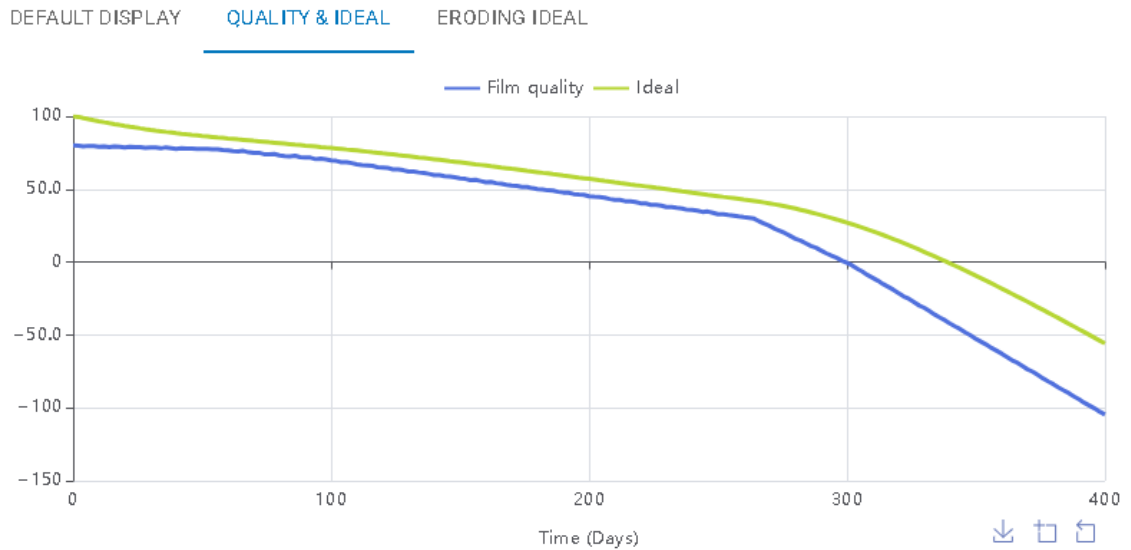
Results for the first 15 steps in Insight Maker for experiment with balanced event coefficients are shown in Figure 3. Dynamics of film quality, the ideal, and eroding ideal over 400 steps are shown in Figures 4 and 5.

Figure 3. Model results with balanced event coefficients

Default Display		Quality & Ideal		Eroding Ideal										
Time	Community support!	Money injection!	Quality improvement	Film quality	Decrease in quality	Schedule pressure!	Compromise!	Budget pressure!	Injection	Film budget	Expenses	Ideal gap	Ideal	Eroding ideal
0	0	0	0	80	0	0	0	0	0	1,800,000	90,000	20	100	0
1	0	0.5	0.5	80	0.6	0.2	0	0.4	400,000	1,710,000	90,000	20	100	0.4
2	0	0.5	0.5	79.9	0.6	0.2	0	0.4	400,000	2,020,000	90,000	19.7	99.6	0.394
3	0	0.5	0.5	79.8	0.9	0.2	0.3	0.4	400,000	2,330,000	90,000	19.406	99.206	0.38812
4	0	0.5	0.5	79.4	0.6	0.2	0	0.4	400,000	2,640,000	90,000	19.41788	98.81788	0.3883576
5	0	1	1	79.3	0.6	0.2	0	0.4	800,000	2,950,000	90,000	19.1295224	98.4295224	0.382590448
6	0	0.5	0.5	79.7	0.9	0.2	0.3	0.4	400,000	3,660,000	90,000	18.346932	98.046932	0.366938639
7	0.4	0.5	0.9	79.3	0.6	0.2	0	0.4	400,000	3,970,000	90,000	18.3799933	97.6799933	0.367599866
8	0	0.5	0.5	79.6	0.6	0.2	0	0.4	400,000	4,280,000	90,000	17.7123934	97.3123934	0.354247869
9	0	0.5	0.5	79.5	0.9	0.2	0.3	0.4	400,000	4,590,000	90,000	17.4581456	96.9581456	0.349162912
10	0	1	1	79.1	0.6	0.2	0	0.4	800,000	4,900,000	90,000	17.5089827	96.6089827	0.350179653
11	0	0.5	0.5	79.5	0.6	0.2	0	0.4	400,000	5,610,000	90,000	16.758803	96.258803	0.33517606
12	0	0.5	0.5	79.4	0.9	0.2	0.3	0.4	400,000	5,920,000	90,000	16.523627	95.923627	0.330472539
13	0	0.5	0.5	79	0.6	0.2	0	0.4	400,000	6,230,000	90,000	16.5931544	95.5931544	0.331863088
14	0.4	0.5	0.9	78.9	0.6	0.2	0	0.4	400,000	6,540,000	90,000	16.3612913	95.2612913	0.327225827
15	0	1	1	79.2	0.9	0.2	0.3	0.4	800,000	6,850,000	90,000	15.7340655	94.9340655	0.31468131

Note that in Insight Maker, cash injections take effect one step after the condition is met. For an abstract archetype demonstration, this does not matter.

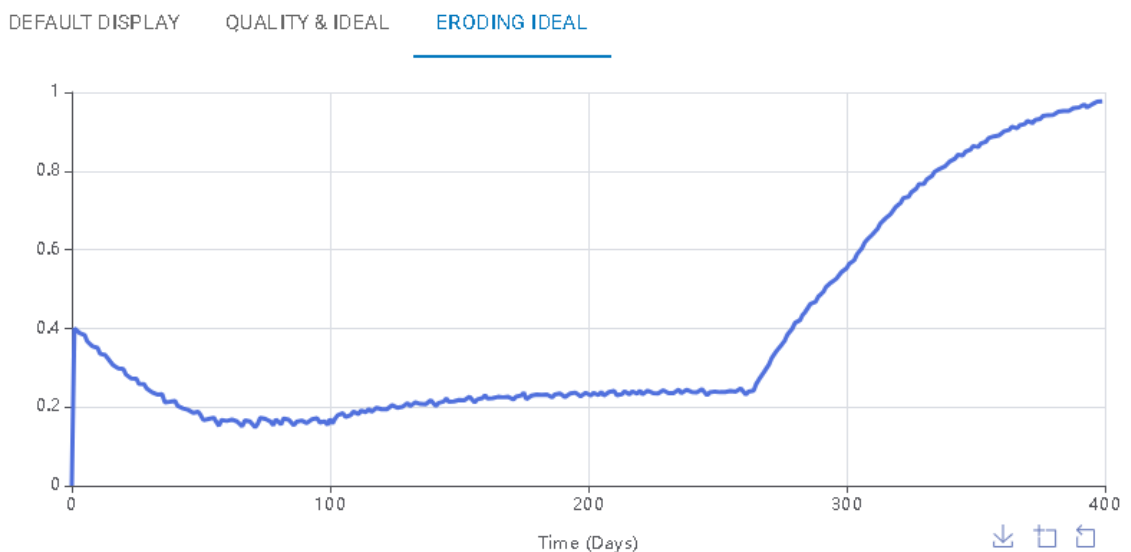
Figure 4. Film quality and ideal dynamics with balanced event coefficients



With balanced coefficients, negative continuous events (budget pressure, schedule pressure, compromises: total 359.9) outweigh periodic positive events (cash injections, community support: total 174.3). The ideal follows quality with a slight delay – realistic for a situation where current conditions are mistaken for following the plan. The film industry, built on endless schedules, fits this archetype well.

Insight Maker does not allow stock limits, but for an abstract archetype this is irrelevant.

Figure 5. Dynamics of eroding ideal with balanced event coefficients



As seen in the quality and ideal graph, at step 264 quality drops below 30%, stopping all cash injections (the film is unlikely to turn a profit). Quality begins to

fall faster, but the ideal remains inertial and follows with a delay. The gap grows until the end of the simulation. A larger gap accelerates ideal erosion.

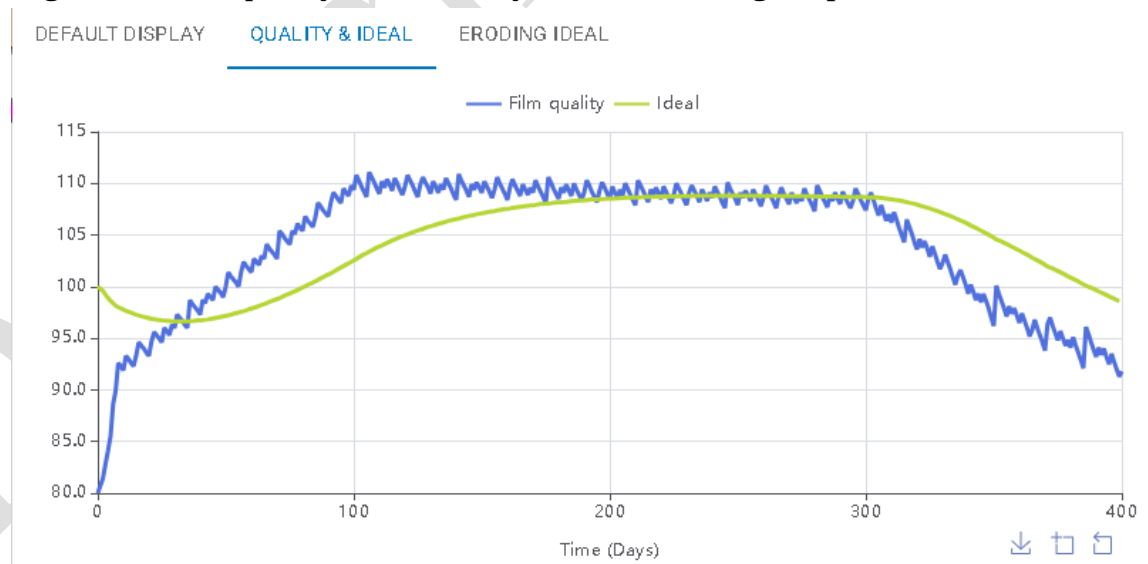
2.2. Experiment with Higher Positive Event Coefficients

Results for the first 15 steps in Insight Maker for experiment with higher positive event coefficients are shown in Figure 6. Dynamics of film quality, the ideal, and eroding ideal over 400 steps are shown in Figures 7 and 8.

Figure 6. Model results with higher positive coefficients

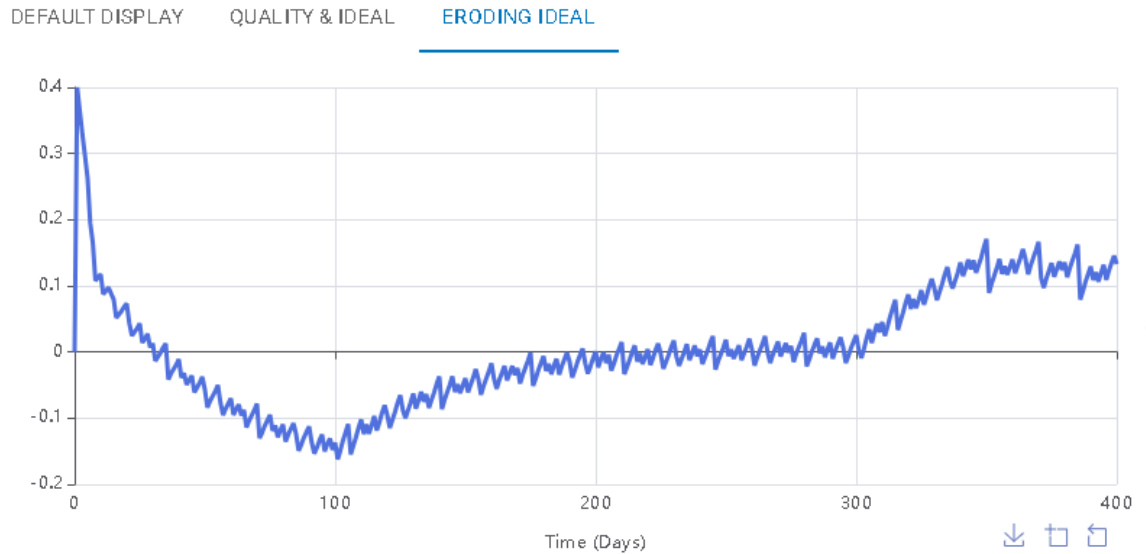
DEFAULT DISPLAY														QUALITY & IDEAL		ERODING IDEAL	
Time	Community support	Money injection	Quality improvement	Film quality	Decrease in quality	Schedule pressure	Compromise	Budget pressure	Injection	Film budget	Expenses	Ideal gap	Ideal	Eroding ide			
0	0	0	0	80	0	0	0	0	0	1,800,000	90,000	20	100	0			
1	0	1.7	1.7	80	0.3	0.2	0	0.1	400,000	1,710,000	90,000	20	100	0.4			
2	0	1.7	1.7	81.4	0.3	0.2	0	0.1	400,000	2,020,000	90,000	18.2	99.6	0.364			
3	0	1.7	1.7	82.8	0.4	0.2	0.1	0.1	400,000	2,330,000	90,000	16.436	99.236	0.32872			
4	0	1.7	1.7	84.1	0.3	0.2	0	0.1	400,000	2,640,000	90,000	14.80728	98.90728	0.2961456			
5	0	3.4	3.4	85.5	0.3	0.2	0	0.1	800,000	2,950,000	90,000	13.1111344	98.6111344	0.2622256			
6	0	1.7	1.7	86.6	0.4	0.2	0.1	0.1	400,000	3,660,000	90,000	9.74891171	98.3489117	0.1949782			
7	1.3	1.7	3	89.9	0.3	0.2	0	0.1	400,000	3,970,000	90,000	8.25393348	98.1539335	0.1650786			
8	0	0	0	92.6	0.3	0.2	0	0.1	0	4,280,000	90,000	5.38885481	97.9888548	0.1077770			
9	0	0	0	92.3	0.4	0.2	0.1	0.1	0	4,190,000	90,000	5.58107771	97.8810777	0.1116216			
10	0	1.7	1.7	91.9	0.3	0.2	0	0.1	400,000	4,100,000	90,000	5.86945616	97.7694562	0.1173891			
11	0	0	0	93.3	0.3	0.2	0	0.1	0	4,410,000	90,000	4.35206703	97.652067	0.0870413			
12	0	0	0	93	0.4	0.2	0.1	0.1	0	4,320,000	90,000	4.56502569	97.5650257	0.0913005			
13	0	0	0	92.6	0.3	0.2	0	0.1	0	4,230,000	90,000	4.87372516	97.4737252	0.0974745			
14	1.3	0	1.3	92.3	0.3	0.2	0	0.1	0	4,140,000	90,000	5.07625068	97.3762507	0.1015250			

Figure 7. Film quality and ideal dynamics with higher positive coefficients



With higher positive event coefficients (positive total 227.1, negative total 214.3), film quality rises to 110% (abstract). After step 200, quality and the ideal converge around 108–109% and remain above the initial value.

Figure 8. Dynamics of eroding ideal with higher positive coefficients



The eroding ideal graph confirms the minimum discrepancy between quality and ideal between steps 200 and 300. After step 300, quality drops sharply due to increased schedule pressure, while the ideal lags behind.

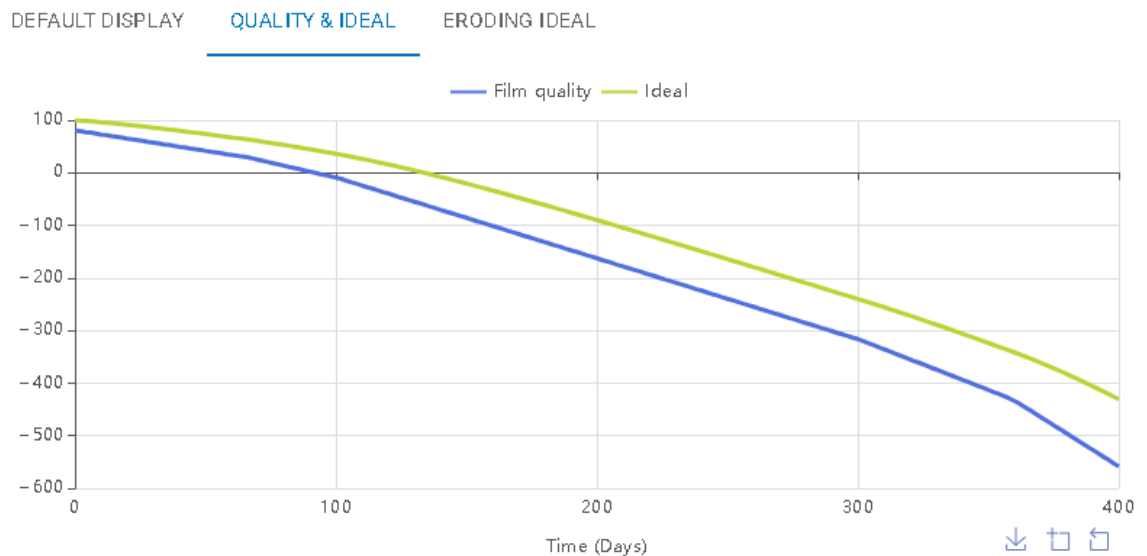
2.3. Experiment with Higher Negative Event Coefficients

Results for the first 15 steps in Insight Maker for experiment with higher negative event coefficients are shown in Figure 9. Dynamics of film quality, the ideal, and eroding ideal over 400 steps are shown in Figures 10 and 11.

Figure 9. Model results with higher negative coefficients

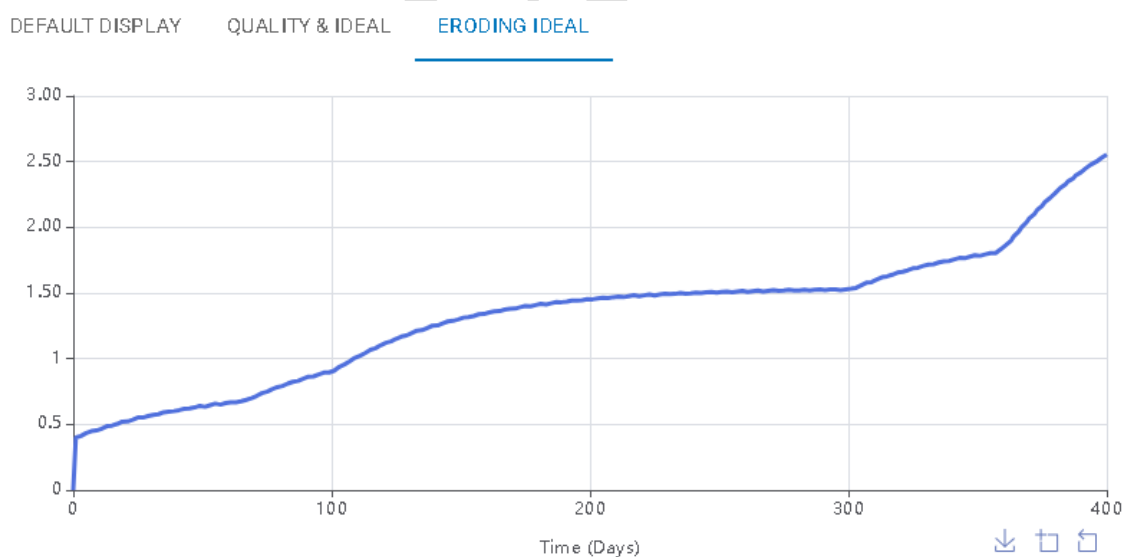
Time	Community support	Money injection	Quality improvement	Film quality	Decrease in quality	Schedule pressure	Compromise	Budget pressure	Injection	Film budget	Expenses	Ideal gap	Ideal	Eroding ideal
0	0	0	0	80	0	0	0	0	0	1,800,000	90,000	20	100	0
1	0	0.3	0.3	80	1	0.4	0	0.6	400,000	1,710,000	90,000	20	100	0.4
2	0	0.3	0.3	79.3	1	0.4	0	0.6	400,000	2,020,000	90,000	20.3	99.6	0.406
3	0	0.3	0.3	78.6	1.5	0.4	0.5	0.6	400,000	2,330,000	90,000	20.594	99.194	0.41188
4	0	0.3	0.3	77.4	1	0.4	0	0.6	400,000	2,640,000	90,000	21.38212	98.78212	0.4276424
5	0	0.6	0.6	76.7	1	0.4	0	0.6	800,000	2,950,000	90,000	21.6544776	98.3544776	0.433089552
6	0	0.3	0.3	76.3	1.5	0.4	0.5	0.6	400,000	3,660,000	90,000	21.621388	97.921388	0.432427761
7	0.2	0.3	0.5	75.1	1	0.4	0	0.6	400,000	3,970,000	90,000	22.3889603	97.4889603	0.447779206
8	0	0.3	0.3	74.6	1	0.4	0	0.6	400,000	4,280,000	90,000	22.4411811	97.0411811	0.448823622
9	0	0.3	0.3	73.9	1.5	0.4	0.5	0.6	400,000	4,590,000	90,000	22.6923575	96.5923575	0.453847149
10	0	0.6	0.6	72.7	1	0.4	0	0.6	800,000	4,900,000	90,000	23.4385103	96.1385103	0.468770206
11	0	0.3	0.3	72.3	1	0.4	0	0.6	400,000	5,610,000	90,000	23.3697401	95.6697401	0.467394802
12	0	0.3	0.3	71.6	1.5	0.4	0.5	0.6	400,000	5,920,000	90,000	23.6023453	95.2023453	0.472046906
13	0	0.3	0.3	70.4	1	0.4	0	0.6	400,000	6,230,000	90,000	24.3302984	94.7302984	0.486050968
14	0.2	0.3	0.5	69.7	1	0.4	0	0.6	400,000	6,540,000	90,000	24.5436924	94.2436924	0.490873849
15	0	0.6	0.6	69.2	1.5	0.4	0.5	0.6	800,000	6,850,000	90,000	24.5528186	93.7528186	0.491056372

Figure 10. Film quality and ideal dynamics with higher negative coefficients



With higher negative coefficients (positive total 34.8, negative total 676.3), film quality drops below zero by step 92. The ideal follows inertially with a delay.

Figure 11. Dynamics of eroding ideal with higher negative coefficients



The gap between quality and ideal continues to grow until the end, as quality falls faster than external events can adapt. A larger gap accelerates ideal erosion.

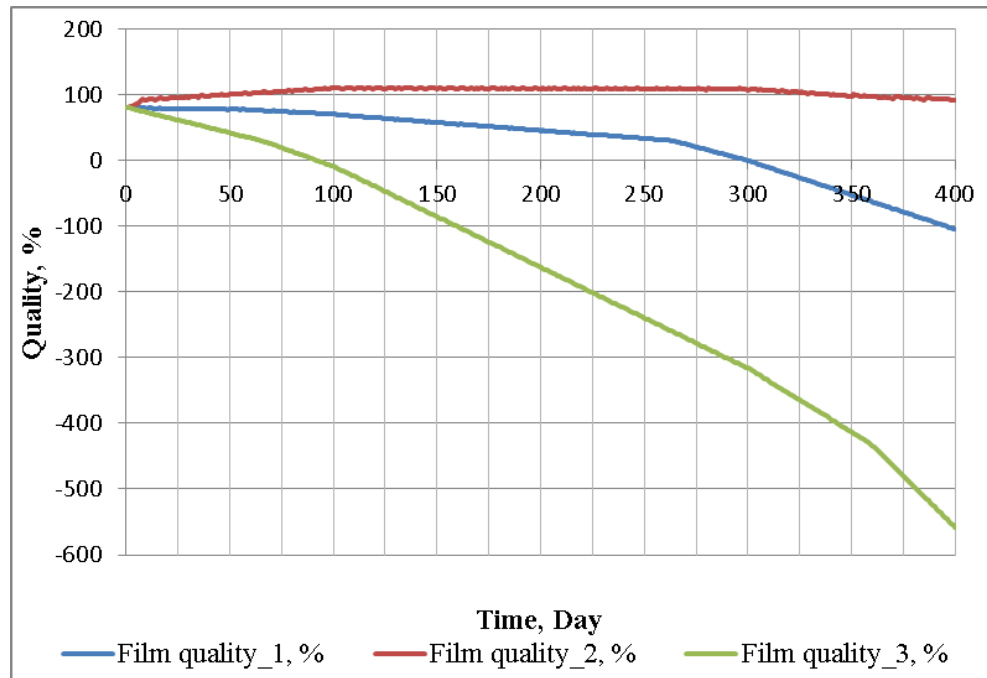
3. Results

Comparative graphs for all three experiments are presented below. For convenience, all calculations were transferred to Excel; a summary table for the first 30 steps is shown in Figure 12. Comparative dynamics of film quality (Figure 13), the ideal (Figure 14), and goal erosion (Figure 15) over the entire time horizon are also shown.

Figure 12. Summary table for the three experiments

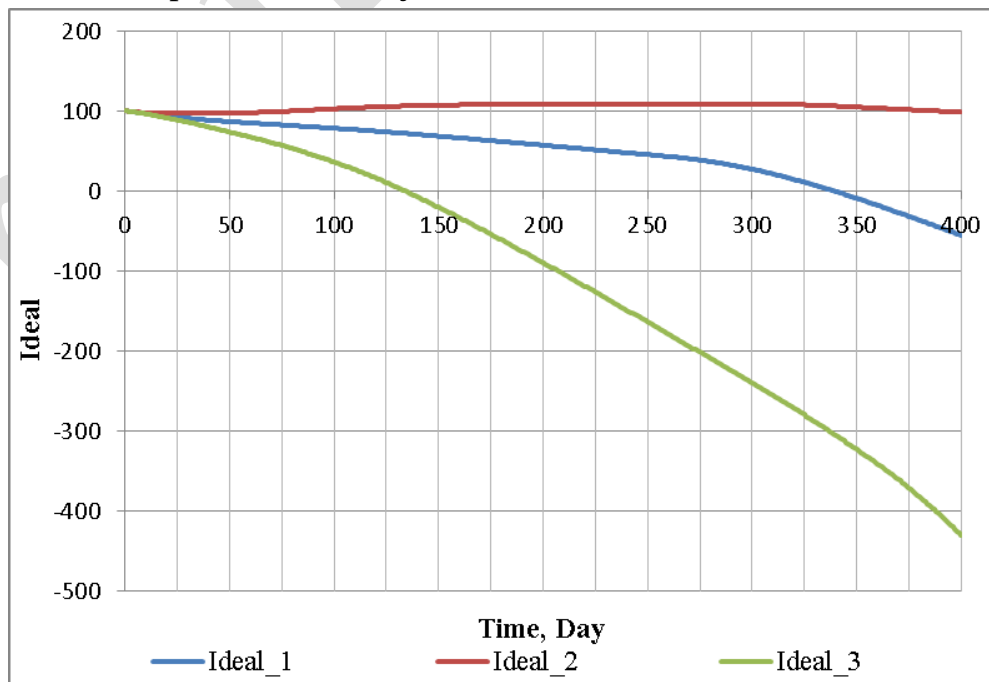
	Community support, %			Money injection, %			Quality improvement, %/Day			Film quality, %			Decrease in quality, %/Day			Schedule pressure, %			Compromise, %			Budget pressure, %			Film budget, \$			Ideal (goal) gap			Ideal			Eroding ideal (goal)			
	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3	Mod_1/Mod_2/Mod_3						
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	80	80	80	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1 800 000,00	1 800 000,00	1 800 000,00	20,00	20,00	20,00	100,00	100,00	100,00	0,00	0,00	0,00	0	
1	0	0	0	0,5	1,7	0,3	0,5	1,7	0,3	80	80	80	0,6	0,3	1	0,2	0,2	0,4	0	0	0	0,4	0,1	0,6	1 710 000,00	1 710 000,00	1 710 000,00	20,00	20,00	20,00	100,00	100,00	100,00	0,40	0,40	0,40	1
2	0	0	0	0,5	1,7	0,3	0,5	1,7	0,3	79,9	81,4	79,3	0,6	0,3	1	0,2	0,2	0,4	0	0	0	0,4	0,1	0,6	2 020 000,00	2 020 000,00	2 020 000,00	19,70	18,20	20,30	99,60	99,60	99,60	0,39	0,36	0,41	2
3	0	0	0	0,5	1,7	0,3	0,5	1,7	0,3	79,8	82,8	78,6	0,9	0,4	1,5	0,2	0,2	0,4	0,3	0,1	0,5	0,4	0,1	0,6	2 330 000,00	2 330 000,00	2 330 000,00	19,41	16,44	20,59	99,21	99,24	99,19	0,39	0,33	0,41	3
4	0	0	0	0,5	1,7	0,3	0,5	1,7	0,3	79,4	84,1	77,4	0,6	0,3	1	0,2	0,2	0,4	0	0	0	0,4	0,1	0,6	2 640 000,00	2 640 000,00	2 640 000,00	19,42	14,81	21,38	98,82	98,91	98,78	0,39	0,30	0,43	4
5	0	0	0	1	3,4	0,6	1	3,4	0,6	79,3	85,5	76,7	0,6	0,3	1	0,2	0,2	0,4	0	0	0	0,4	0,1	0,6	2 950 000,00	2 950 000,00	2 950 000,00	19,13	13,11	21,65	98,43	98,61	98,35	0,38	0,26	0,43	5
6	0	0	0	0,5	1,7	0,3	0,5	1,7	0,3	79,7	88,6	76,3	0,9	0,4	1,5	0,2	0,2	0,4	0,3	0,1	0,5	0,4	0,1	0,6	3 660 000,00	3 660 000,00	3 660 000,00	18,35	9,75	21,62	98,05	98,35	97,92	0,37	0,19	0,43	6
7	0,4	1,3	0,2	0,5	1,7	0,3	0,9	3	0,5	79,3	89,9	75,1	0,6	0,3	1	0,2	0,2	0,4	0	0	0	0,4	0,1	0,6	3 970 000,00	3 970 000,00	3 970 000,00	18,38	8,25	22,39	97,68	98,15	97,49	0,37	0,17	0,45	7
8	0	0	0	0,5	0	0,3	0,5	0	0,3	79,6	92,6	74,6	0,6	0,3	1	0,2	0,2	0,4	0	0	0	0,4	0,1	0,6	4 280 000,00	4 280 000,00	4 280 000,00	17,71	5,39	22,44	97,31	97,99	97,04	0,35	0,11	0,45	8
9	0	0	0	0,5	0	0,3	0,5	0	0,3	79,5	92,3	73,9	0,9	0,4	1,5	0,2	0,2	0,4	0,3	0,1	0,5	0,4	0,1	0,6	4 590 000,00	4 190 000,00	4 590 000,00	17,46	5,58	22,69	96,96	97,88	96,59	0,35	0,11	0,45	9
10	0	0	0	1	1,7	0,6	1	1,7	0,6	79,1	91,9	72,7	0,6	0,3	1	0,2	0,2	0,4	0	0	0	0,4	0,1	0,6	4 900 000,00	4 100 000,00	4 900 000,00	17,51	5,87	23,44	96,61	97,77	96,14	0,35	0,12	0,47	10
11	0	0	0	0,5	0	0,3	0,5	0	0,3	79,5	93,3	72,3	0,6	0,3	1	0,2	0,2	0,4	0	0	0	0,4	0,1	0,6	5 610 000,00	4 410 000,00	5 610 000,00	16,76	4,35	23,37	96,26	97,65	95,67	0,34	0,09	0,47	11
12	0	0	0	0,5	0	0,3	0,5	0	0,3	79,4	93	71,6	0,9	0,4	1,5	0,2	0,2	0,4	0,3	0,1	0,5	0,4	0,1	0,6	5 920 000,00	4 320 000,00	5 920 000,00	16,52	4,57	23,60	95,92	97,57	95,20	0,33	0,09	0,47	12
13	0	0	0	0,5	0	0,3	0,5	0	0,3	79	92,6	70,4	0,6	0,3	1	0,2	0,2	0,4	0	0	0	0,4	0,1	0,6	6 230 000,00	4 230 000,00	6 230 000,00	16,59	4,87	24,33	95,59	97,47	94,73	0,33	0,10	0,49	13
14	0,4	1,3	0,2	0,5	0	0,3	0,9	1,3	0,5	78,9	92,3	69,7	0,6	0,3	1	0,2	0,2	0,4	0	0	0	0,4	0,1	0,6	6 540 000,00	4 140 000,00	6 540 000,00	16,36	5,08	24,54	95,26	97,38	94,24	0,33	0,10	0,49	14
15	0	0	0	1	1,7	0,6	1	1,7	0,6	79,2	93,3	69,2	0,9	0,4	1,5	0,2	0,2	0,4	0,3	0,1	0,5	0,4	0,1	0,6	6 850 000,00	4 050 000,00	6 850 000,00	15,73	3,97	24,55	94,93	97,27	93,75	0,31	0,08	0,49	15
16	0	0	0	0,5	0	0,3	0,5	0	0,3	79,3	94,6	68,3	0,6	0,3	1	0,2	0,2	0,4	0	0	0	0,4	0,1	0,6	7 560 000,00	4 360 000,00	7 560 000,00	15,32	2,60	24,96	94,62	97,20	93,26	0,31	0,05	0,50	16
17	0	0	0	0,5	0	0,3	0,5	0	0,3	79,2	94,3	67,6	0,6	0,3	1	0,2	0,2	0,4	0	0	0	0,4	0,1	0,6	7 870 000,00	4 270 000,00	7 870 000,00	15,11	2,84	25,16	94,31	97,14	92,76	0,30	0,06	0,50	17
18	0	0	0	0,5	0	0,3	0,5	0	0,3	79,1	94	66,9	0,9	0,4	1,5	0,2	0,2	0,4	0,3	0,1	0,5	0,4	0,1	0,6	8 180 000,00	4 180 000,00	8 180 000,00	14,91	3,09	25,36	94,01	97,09	92,26	0,30	0,06	0,51	18
19	0	0	0	0,5	0	0,3	0,5	0	0,3	78,7	93,6	65,7	0,6	0,3	1	0,2	0,2	0,4	0	0	0	0,4	0,1	0,6	8 490 000,00	4 090 000,00	8 490 000,00	15,01	3,42	26,05	93,71	97,02	91,75	0,30	0,07	0,52	19
20	0	0	0	1	1,7	0,6	1	1,7	0,6	78,6	93,3	65	0,6	0,3	1	0,2	0,2	0,4	0	0	0	0,4	0,1	0,6	8 800 000,00	4 000 000,00	8 800 000,00	14,81	3,66	26,23	93,41	96,96	91,23	0,30	0,07	0,52	20
21	0,4	1,3	0,2	0,5	0	0,3	0,9	1,3	0,5	79	94,7	64,6	0,9	0,4	1,5	0,2	0,2	0,4	0,3	0,1	0,5	0,4	0,1	0,6	9 510 000,00	4 310 000,00	9 510 000,00	14,12	2,18	26,11	93,12	96,88	90,71	0,28	0,04	0,52	21
22	0	0	0	0,5	0	0,3	0,5	0	0,3	79	95,6	63,6	0,6	0,3	1	0,2	0,2	0,4	0	0	0	0,4	0,1	0,6	9 820 000,00	4 220 000,00	9 820 000,00	13,83	1,24	26,58	92,83	96,84	90,18	0,28	0,02	0,53	22
23	0	0	0	0,5	0	0,3	0,5	0	0,3	78,9	95,3	62,9	0,6	0,3	1	0,2	0,2	0,4	0	0	0	0,4	0,1	0,6	10 130 000,00	4 130 000,00	10 130 000,00	13,66	1,51	26,75	92,56	96,81	89,65	0,27	0,03	0,54	23
24	0	0	0	0,5	0	0,3	0,5	0	0,3	78,8	95	62,2	0,9	0,4	1,5	0,2	0,2	0,4	0,3	0,1	0,5	0,4	0,1	0,6	10 440 000,00	4 040 000,00	10 440 000,00	13,48	1,78	26,92	92,28	96,78	89,12	0,27	0,04	0,54	24
25	0	0	0	1	1,7	0,6	1	1,7	0,6	78,4	94,6	61	0,6	0,3	1	0,2	0,2	0,4	0	0	0	0,4	0,1	0,6	10 750 000,00	3 950 000,00	10 750 000,00	13,61	2,15	27,58	92,01	96,75	88,58	0,27	0,04	0,55	25
26	0	0	0	0,5	0	0,3	0,5	0	0,3	78,8	96	60,6	0,6	0,3	1	0,2	0,2	0,4	0	0	0	0,4	0,1	0,6	11 460 000,00	4 260 000,00	11 460 000,00	12,94	0,71	27,43	91,74	96,71	88,03	0,26	0,01	0,55	26
27	0	0	0	0,5	0	0,3	0,5	0	0,3	78,7	95,7	59,9	0,9	0,4	1,5	0,2	0,2	0,4	0,3	0,1	0,5	0,4	0,1	0,6	11 770 000,00	4 170 000,00	11 770 000,00	12,78	0,99	27,58	91,48	96,69	87,48	0,26	0,02	0,55	27
28	0,4	1,3	0,2	0,5	0	0,3	0,9	1,3	0,5	78,3	95,3	58,7	0,6	0,3	1	0,2	0,2	0,4	0	0	0	0,4	0,1	0,6	12 080 000,00	4 080 000,00	12 080 000,00	12,93	1,37	28,23	91,23	96,67	86,93	0,26	0,03	0,56	28
29	0	0	0	0,5	0	0,3	0,5	0	0,3	78,6	96,3	58,2	0,6	0,3	1	0,2	0,2	0,4	0	0	0	0,4	0,1	0,6	12 390 000,00	3 990 000,00	12 390 000,00	12,37	0,34	28,16	90,97	96,64	86,36	0,25	0,01	0,56	29
30	0	0	0	1	1,7	0,6	1	1,7	0,6	78,5	96	57,5	0,9	0,4	1,5	0,2	0,2	0,4	0,3	0,1	0,5	0,4	0,1	0,6	12 700 000,00	3 900 000,00	12 700 000,00	12,22	0,64	28,30	90,72	96,64	85,80	0,24	0,01	0,57	30

Figure 13. Comparative film quality dynamics



Only Experiment 2 was successful in maintaining film quality. Strengthening positive events predictably improves quality, but negative events — though smaller in coefficient — act continuously, unlike one-time money injections or occasional community support.

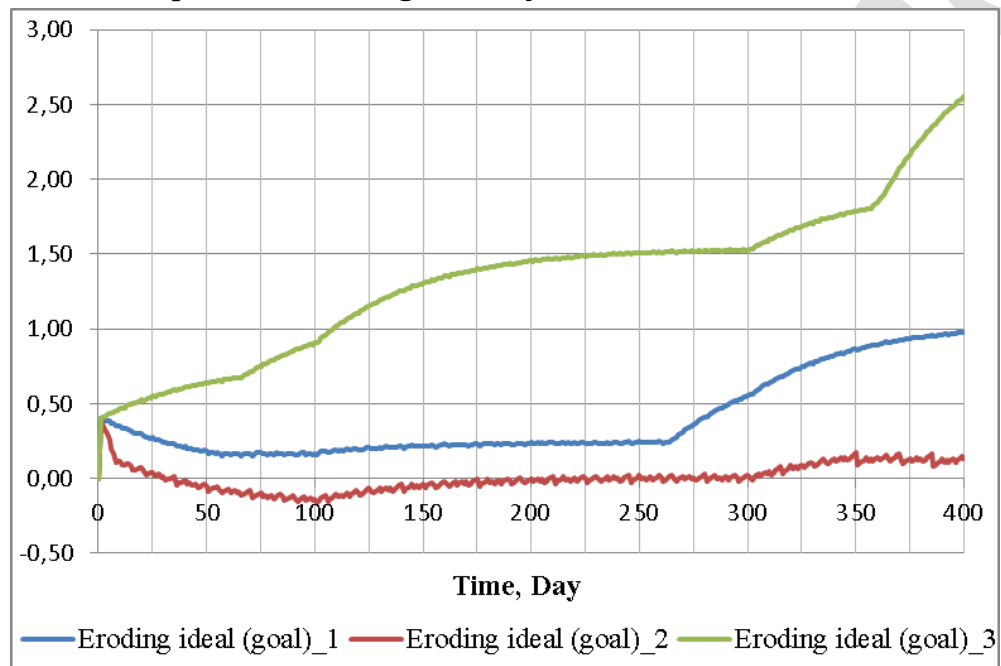
Figure 14. Comparative ideal dynamics



The ideal follows quality with a delay. Quality changes under the influence of external events; the ideal changes under the influence of the gap between it and quality. The erosion rate is constant (0.02) across all experiments, creating a delay but showing that external events dominate.

Real systems behave similarly. People do not change their standards instantly. First they see a decline in quality, then they gradually adapt to the new reality — this is goal erosion.

Figure 15. Comparative eroding ideal dynamics



Ideal erosion is slowest in Experiment 2, where values remain within ± 0.15 . The fastest erosion occurs in Experiment 3, where film quality falls much faster than the ideal can follow. A larger gap produces stronger goal erosion.

4. Conclusion

This work examined the "Eroding Goals" archetype in the context of film production. Three scenarios were considered: balanced event coefficients, higher positive event coefficients, and higher negative event coefficients. The main findings are:

- 1) Negative events have a greater impact. Even with balanced coefficients, constant schedule pressure, budget pressure, and compromises outweigh periodic positive events. Quality and the ideal decline, increasing the gap and accelerating goal erosion.

2) Strengthening positive events stabilises the system. Quality rises above 100% and remains above the initial level until the end of the simulation. The gap and the erosion ideal are minimal.

3) Strengthening negative events leads to collapse. Quality drops sharply below zero, the ideal cannot keep up, and the gap grows uncontrollably.

4) The ideal follows quality with a delay. This reflects real human behaviour: standards change not instantly but gradually, under the influence of a deteriorating reality.

Thus, the "Eroding Goals" archetype clearly demonstrates how constant pressure from negative factors lowers standards, while positive events — even periodic ones — can stabilise the system. The most dangerous situation is when negative events dominate, leading to irreversible quality decline.

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